

PRODUCT STRATEGY · CONFIDENTIAL

HearMe

Competitive Analysis & Unique Feature Roadmap

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Product: HearMe — Women's Personal Safety App

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1. Executive Summary

HearMe is a React Native / Expo based women's personal safety app targeting the Indian market. It already ships a set of features that are common across mainstream safety apps (shake-to-SOS, journey monitor, evidence locker, fake call, emergency SMS) and one category of features that is genuinely novel: **behavioural biometrics** — panic-pattern tap detection, coercion hesitation, phone-handoff detection, and a 0–100 Trust Engine score.

Core insight: HearMe's behavioural biometrics are not present in any mainstream women's safety app on the Play Store. This is the moat. The opportunity is to (a) close the parity gap on standard SOS features and (b) stack *coercion-resistant* UX patterns on top of the biometric core — creating an app attackers cannot easily disable even with the phone in hand.

2. Competitive Landscape

App	Core Strength	Weakness vs. HearMe Opportunity
bSafe	Live audio/video stream, fake call, follow-me	No behavioural AI; subscription paywall; western-centric UX
Noonlight	24/7 human dispatcher routes police directly	US-only; no India / 112 integration
Life360	Family location circle + driving reports	Not SOS-first; privacy criticism; no distress detection
SafetiPin	Crowd-sourced area safety scores	No personal distress detection or SOS pipeline
Raksha / Himmat	Govt police linkage	Outdated UX; no AI; poor offline handling
Kitestring	Smart check-ins ("reply or I call help")	Text-only; no sensors, no evidence
Citizen	Real-time crime heatmap	Voyeuristic; US-only; no personal safety layer
VithU / CircleOf6	Simple SOS circle	Minimal features; no active detection

3. Where HearMe Already Leads

- Moat **Behavioural biometrics** — panic tap, coercion hesitation, phone handoff, inactivity alerts.
- Moat **Trust Engine 0–100 score** with normal / unusual / suspect / alert bands.
- Parity Shake-to-SOS, GPS emergency SMS, evidence locker, journey monitor.
- Parity Speed tracker with crash-detection logic, nearby services, fake call.
- Parity Full i18n scaffold (48 KB language file) ready for regional rollout.

4. Unique Differentiators to Add (Your Moat)

These features, to the best of current market knowledge, are *not* shipped by any mainstream competitor in the personal-safety category.

1. Duress PIN / Reverse PIN Unlock

Unique

Correct PIN unlocks normally; reverse PIN unlocks a *decoy* home screen while silently triggering SOS. A banking-grade pattern absent from every mainstream safety app.

2. Disguised-UI Mode

Unique

Launcher icon and splash can impersonate a calculator, notes, or weather app. Single toggle in settings. Lifesaving in forced-unlock or phone-snatch scenarios.

3. Voice-Keyword Trigger

Unique

On-device Whisper / Vosk listens for a user-defined safe word (e.g. "mausam kaisa hai"). Zero cloud upload until triggered. Works screen-off.

4. Coercion-Aware Fake Deactivation

Unique

If an attacker forces the user to uninstall or disable, the app *appears* to turn off but retains a 30-minute grace trigger. Requires Android foreground-service hygiene.

5. AI Threat-Narrator

Unique

During an active SOS, an on-device LLM (Gemini Nano) auto-transcribes recorded audio and generates a timeline summary — e.g. "raised voices at 21:04, vehicle start at 21:06" — attached to the evidence bundle.

6. Bluetooth-Mesh SOS

Unique

When no cellular is available, broadcast SOS to any HearMe user within ~100 m (Bridgefy-style mesh). Critical for metros, tunnels, rural zones.

7. Safe-Route AI

Unique

Overlay on Google Maps that re-routes around low-safety zones using your crowd heatmap and NCRB open-crime data (India).

8. Guardian Mode (Peer Live-Watch)

Unique

Any trusted contact across the city can live-watch your journey on their phone and confirm "I'm watching." Reduces escalation burden on police.

9. Post-Incident Auto-FIR Draft

Unique

Uses evidence timeline + location + transcript to pre-fill an FIR PDF compatible with state police portals. Major value in India.

10. Wearable & Panic-Button Integration

Unique

Apple Watch, Noise / boAt smartwatches, and Bluetooth keychain panic buttons (~₹300). Triple-press triggers SOS even when the phone is locked in a bag.

5. Industry-Standard Features Currently Missing

Feature	Why It Matters
Live audio/video streaming during SOS	Table-stakes vs. bSafe; reduces evidence loss if phone is destroyed.
Timer check-ins (Kitestring pattern)	"I'll be home by 10:30 — ping me." Covers low-intensity risk well.
Cloud-synced, E2E-encrypted evidence	Today evidence is local-only; courts need tamper-proof timestamps (hash-chain / Object-Lock).
112 / state-police API integration	India's 112 service offers an official SOS API — direct dispatcher route.
Family Circle / group journey	Life360-style parity for household users.
Heart-rate distress trigger	Via connected wearables — elevated HR + anomaly = stronger signal.
Quick-settings tile / Action Button / lock-screen widget	One-tap SOS without unlocking.
Accessibility: TalkBack, dyslexia font, regional TTS	Your i18n is already wired — just add TTS + a11y audits.
Offline-first + E2E encryption of contacts	libsignal / tweetnacl for contacts and evidence metadata.
One-handed mode & dark-mode	Distress UX fundamentals.

6. Trust, Compliance & Monetisation

- **Subscription tier (Noonlight model):** 24/7 human dispatcher via a partnered private-security firm.
- **Compliance:** SOC 2 + India DPDP Act badges in onboarding — trust is a conversion lever.
- **Open-source the Trust Engine:** reinforces credibility (you already adapted PhishSafe) and invites academic validation.
- **Institutional partnerships:** Ola / Uber / Rapido integration; campus safety programmes; NGO distribution.

7. Recommended Ship Order

PHASE 1 · 0–4 WEEKS	PHASE 2 · 4–8 WEEKS	PHASE 3 · 8–12 WEEKS
• Duress PIN / reverse PIN • Disguised-UI mode	• Guardian-mode peer watching	• AI Threat Narrator • Auto-FIR draft generator

• Voice-keyword trigger • Cloud-encrypted evidence sync • Live audio streaming	• Bluetooth-mesh SOS • Wearable + panic-button support • 112 / state-police API • Timer check-ins	• Safe-Route AI overlay • Family Circle / group journeys • Subscription dispatcher tier
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Recommendation: Start with *Duress PIN, Disguised UI, and Voice Trigger*. Combined with the existing behavioural biometrics, these three features alone put HearMe ahead of every mainstream safety app on the Play Store today — and each is achievable in a single sprint using the stack already in place.

8. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
False positives on behavioural alerts	Graduated response: local vibration → check-in prompt → SOS after 15 s no-cancel.
Battery drain from always-on sensors / voice trigger	Keep voice-keyword model on-device, VAD-gated; sensors sampled at 5 Hz off-motion.
Evidence tampering allegations in court	Hash-chain + Supabase Object Lock + server-side timestamp signature.
Police-API reliability across states	Fallback: SMS to 112 + WhatsApp Business template + email to state helpline.
Disguised-UI rejection on iOS	Use Alternate Icons API (iOS-approved) rather than full launcher spoof.